

From A Hacker's Diary

Coding the Freedom using V and Grogammer

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I always have this problem with my memory. Keeping up with new syntax and functions has always troubled me. So was the case when I was learning AIML (Artificially Intelligent Markup Language) and the Program E. I really got enticed by the working of A.L.I.C.E and that made me run after AIML. And finally encountered E on the SourceForge server.

I cannot simply neglect languages like TK if I want to make my software user-friendly. I always wondered whether I could write these programs in a single language, and finally convert it to the language that I want. Yet, I have wondered whether I can have such a language.

I spent days trying to work out a solution. The driving force behind the search was simply one idea—to write an algorithm I needed to use my brain, but after I wrote that, I had to use reference books to look for syntaxes and functions. This way, I was hardly using any element of my brain. The result of my experiments was the V language (www.vlanguage.org)—where one can write programs in plain English and convert them to any language they desire.

I remember someone asking me once why languages required syntaxes. As I explained the need, the conversation made me think about the M-Programmers version of V.

Many of my earlier projects were written in PHP. Employing the same, I further proceeded to come out with a Web version the project Grogammer (www.grogammer.com). The initial deployment of V over this interface is delivered through PHP. There were two reasons why I thought it was very essential to have such a Web interface. First being the fact that Netizens can try out the project even before the libraries are out. And secondly, I may get more developers, especially to add support to new languages, for the project.

For a person to write programs in their mother tongue, I employed some tools that I

used for the Mozhi Search Engine. Though V eliminates the need to have different programming languages, some of the developers suggested having a version that allows the programmer to write programs using a very simple and short syntax, to shun the pains of typing long lines. However, the M-programmers version still remains (under development), as the need of the hour.

Now we are looking for more developers who are proficient in artificial intelligence (AI) and Artificial Neural Networking (ANN). They can contribute a lot to the upcoming stages, where V can suggest solutions for the problem. Implementation of AI in V will further solve the problem with a preferred syntax for V—in short, you will be able to ask V to do what ever you want it to! V will be able to understand you if you follow grammatical rules—of the language in which you are typing. Some of the developers (in a recent Web-conference) proposed ideas to build speech recognition techniques that could be incorporated into the V platform. Of course, I still have a long way to go before V can be that “commanding”.

Yesterday, while I was frequently checking the libraries of GNU PDF—another free implementation by GNU!, and conforming to the PDF 1.7 specification—especially the group of specific subsets of PDF conforming to the ISO standards PDF/A, PDF/X and ISO 32000. I was really enticed by some features like annotations and interactive forms used in that.

I have to help a friend from the multimedia production industry in installing dyne:bolic—a Free OS for people in the multimedia side, which has a wonderful collection of tools to record, edit, encode and stream. But I love doing that. One can enjoy the true spirit of GNU only if he is gifted to touch the pulse of the community. Yet, after many days of work, today I succeeded in finishing the stage 3 of Grogammer. ☒

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“The need of the hour is for developers who are proficient in Artificial Intelligence and Artificial Neural Networking”

About the Writer

The writer is the developer of Mozhi (www.mozhi.org)—an Indian Language search engine, and the CEO of The Analyst Magazine (www.theanalystmagazine.com) and Free Lecture Notes (www.freelecturenotes.org). His research work / publications in Computer Science and Physics are available at www.aasisvinayak.com.

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